

Task 2 – Trend Analysis

In this task, you will extend your analysis beyond a single year. You will analyze a DAX40 company **over several years**, identifying positive or negative trends and interpreting them with the help of information from the company's communication channels. The aim is to practice time-series financial analysis and link the numbers to company decisions, strategic actions, or external events.

Instructions:

1. Choose a DAX40 company

Begin by selecting one of the DAX40 companies from the provided data set where you expect either a positive or negative trend over the available time period. Base your choice either on an initial scan of the data or on your expectations of the company's performance.

If you expect such trends in the company from Task 1, you can extend your analysis. However, you can also choose a different company.

2. Analyze ratios over time

To gain a comprehensive view of the company's financials, start by analyzing the ratios introduced in the lecture. Use the values for all available years in the dataset to show the development of the financials and identify trends. Calculate and analyze **at least 2 ratios per ratio category** (activity, profitability, solvency, liquidity). You may add further ratios if you think they provide additional insight.

3. Visualize your analysis in Tableau

Create a Tableau dashboard to illustrate these trends and your findings. Use time-based visuals to highlight the year-over-year changes in financial metrics. Your dashboard should be visually appealing, easy to interpret, and structured to convey key insights about the company's financial situation.

4. Documentation – Interpret the trends

Your documentation should include:

- **Company choice:** Why did you pick this company? What trends do you expect, and why?
- **Method & ratios:** Which ratios did you calculate and why? Did you face any challenges (e.g., missing values, misleading naming)?
- **Results:** What do the ratios tell you about the company's financials? How have the ratios developed over time?
- **Investment recommendation:** Based on your analysis of the company, what is your final assessment? Would you invest in the company or not?

Your documentation should not exceed **3 pages**. Please focus on presenting the key points in a concise and structured way.